

Risk Assessment

Premises and activity-specific hazard, control and review record

15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE · Alternative Provision for Ages 5–25

ADOPTED POLICY

This policy has been formally adopted by L-Fit Pathways' co-directors and is in effect from the date shown below. Any section still shown in [square brackets and amber text] is organisation-specific detail that remains to be confirmed and inserted - it does not affect the rest of the policy's validity but should be completed as soon as possible.

Version: 1.0 (Adopted)

Date Adopted: 16 September 2026

Next Review Due: 16 September 2027 (or sooner following any legislative change or safeguarding incident)

1. Purpose & Scope

This risk assessment covers the premises at 15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE and all L-Fit Pathways provision delivered there or off-site: Forest School, Animal Assisted Learning, Educational Tuition, Boxing Fitness & Discipline, Life Skills, Digital Detox, Reintegration & Transition support, and our community Wellbeing Hub sessions. It should be read alongside the Health & Safety Policy and reviewed at least annually, before any new activity is introduced, and immediately after any incident.

Risk rating uses a simple Likelihood (1–3) × Severity (1–3) scale: Low (1–3), Medium (4–6), High (7–9). Ratings below assume the existing controls listed are in place; owners must reassess if controls lapse.

2. Premises — 15-17 Irlam Road, Bootle, Liverpool, L20 4AE

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
Fire	All	Fire alarm, extinguishers, marked exits, evacuation procedure explained at induction	Medium	<i>[Confirm fire risk assessment date and drill frequency]</i>	<i>[Co-Directors / Annual]</i>
Slips, trips & falls	All	Clear walkways, spillages cleared immediately, adequate lighting	Low	Routine visual checks before each session	Session Lead / Ongoing
Electrical equipment	All	PAT-tested equipment, visual checks before use	Low	<i>[Confirm PAT testing schedule and last test date]</i>	<i>[Co-Directors / Annual]</i>
Unauthorised visitor access (safeguarding)	Young people	Visitor sign-in, staff supervision, main entrance monitored during Wellbeing Hub open-access sessions	Medium	All visitors accompanied at all times; ID checked on arrival	DSLs / Ongoing
First aid	All	Paediatric first-aid	Low	<i>[Confirm named first</i>	<i>[Co-</i>

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
emergency		trained staff on site, stocked first aid kit		<i>aiders and kit check schedule]</i>	<i>Directors / Termly]</i>

3. Forest School / Outdoor Sessions

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
Weather exposure (cold, heat, rain)	Young people, staff	Weather checked before session, appropriate clothing required, sessions adapted/cancelled in severe weather	Medium	Provide spare weatherproof clothing where possible	Session Lead / Each session
Tools (knives, saws, fire-lighting equipment)	Young people	1:1 or small-group supervision during tool use, age/ability-appropriate tasks, tool safety briefing	Medium	<i>[Confirm tool-use ratios and staff Forest School qualification level]</i>	<i>[Session Lead / Annual]</i>
Open fire (where used)	Young people, staff	Fire circle briefing, water/extinguisher on site, fire never left unattended	High	Fire lighting led only by qualified staff; young people supervised at all times	<i>[Confirm Forest School Level 3 leader name]</i>
Terrain, water, wildlife/plants	Young people	Site walked and hazards identified before each session; boundaries set with the group	Medium	Site-specific risk assessment refreshed each season	Session Lead / Seasonal
Ratios / lone working outdoors	Staff	Minimum two staff present on all outdoor sessions	Medium	<i>[Confirm minimum staff ratio per group size]</i>	Co-Directors / Ongoing

4. Animal Assisted Learning

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
Animal behaviour / unpredictability	Young people	Trained handler present at all times, animals assessed as suitable temperament, clear handling rules	Medium	<i>[Confirm handler qualifications and animal welfare assessment records]</i>	Session Lead / Ongoing
Allergies	Young people	Allergy status checked at referral and before each session	Medium	Alternative activity offered where allergy risk identified	DSLs / Each referral
Hygiene / zoonotic infection	Young people, staff	Hand-washing before and after contact, animal areas kept clean	Low	Hand sanitiser available at point of contact	Session Lead / Ongoing
Animal welfare	Animals	Animals housed and cared for in line with the	Low	<i>[Confirm animal welfare/licensing]</i>	Session Lead /

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
		Animal Welfare Act 2006; rest breaks built into sessions		<i>arrangements, e.g. local authority animal activity licence if applicable]</i>	Ongoing

5. Boxing Fitness & Discipline

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
Injury from training	Young people	Non-contact only, correct technique supervision, equipment condition checked before use	Medium	Warm-up/cool-down built into every session; first aider present	Session Lead / Ongoing
Equipment (pads, bags, gloves)	Young people, staff	Visual condition checks before use, replaced when worn	Low	<i>[Confirm equipment inspection schedule]</i>	Session Lead / Termly
Overexertion / medical conditions	Young people	Medical/health information checked at referral, activity adapted to individual ability	Medium	Staff trained to recognise signs of overexertion and pause activity	DSLs / Each referral

6. Educational Tuition & Digital Detox

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
One-to-one setting (safeguarding)	Young people	Sessions held in visible/open areas or with door open where 1:1, staff never alone off-site with a young person unannounced	Medium	Line-of-sight or paired working maintained where possible	DSLs / Ongoing
Device withdrawal anxiety (Digital Detox)	Young people	Clear explanation and consent process before sessions; devices stored securely and returned promptly at session end	Low	Staff trained to support transition and any distress calmly	Session Lead / Ongoing
Device security	Young people	Devices logged in/out, stored in a locked location during detox sessions	Low	<i>[Confirm device storage/security arrangements]</i>	Session Lead / Ongoing

7. Life Skills / Community-Based Sessions

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
Road safety / travel training	Young people	Routes risk-assessed in advance, staff-to-young-person ratios increased for off-site travel	Medium	<i>[Confirm off-site staff ratios and parental consent process]</i>	Session Lead / Each activity

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
Public setting exposure	Young people	Destinations pre-visited/assessed by staff where possible; group stays together with named staff lead	Medium	Emergency contact procedure briefed before departure	Session Lead / Each activity
Lone working (staff)	Staff	Staff check in with a DSL before and after any lone community-based session	<i>[Confirm lone working check-in procedure]</i>	Medium	Co-Directors / Ongoing

8. Community Wellbeing Hub

Hazard	Who's at Risk	Existing Controls	Risk Rating	Additional Controls	Owner / Review
Open-access visitor safeguarding	Young people, visitors	Sign-in at entrance, staff presence during all open sessions, safeguarding of any young people present during open-access hours	Medium	Separate scheduling to avoid open-access and young-person sessions overlapping unsupervised	DSLs / Ongoing
Room capacity / overcrowding	All	Maximum capacity set per room, monitored by staff on duty	Low	<i>[Confirm maximum capacity per room]</i>	Co-Directors / Ongoing

9. Review

This risk assessment is reviewed annually, before any new activity or venue is introduced, and immediately following any accident, incident or near-miss. All session leads must read the relevant section before delivering that activity for the first time.

Risk assessment completed by: Adam Byrne & Craig Lloyd, Co-Directors — Date: 16 September 2026 — Next review due: 16 September 2027